

come in many formats like microSD, miniSD and MemoryStick. The number of photos that a memory card can store depends on the capacity of the card and the photo resolution. On a 2-megapixel camera, a 512MB card may store approximately 1000 photos.

Photo transfer

Normal MMS charges are there, but you can also share photos at nominal charge through the Internet and free through Bluetooth. Time taken is instant for MMS or Bluetooth. E-mail takes its own time.

Other ways to transfer your digital photographs from a camera phone to a PC are via a USB cable, via an infrared port and by memory card transfer.

Bluetooth is a standard feature in all camera phones and it will give you a chance to share your images and other content with your friends and family. You must be already familiar with Bluetooth as a way to use a cellphone with handsfree features or with a headset. Bluetooth may also be used to print photos wirelessly if you have a Bluetooth capable printer. However, not all Bluetooth-capable phones support printing. Look for a phone that has a 'print' feature or 'send' feature that can send a photo to a printer via Bluetooth. Some printers may require an optional Bluetooth adaptor to do this.

PictBridge is a standard way for digital cameras to print photos by directly connecting to a printer using a



Sony Ericsson F305

USB cable. This is still a relatively new feature on cellphones.

Batteries

Flashes can drain the life out of your cellphone battery. The longer the talk time on your cellphone, the better it will be able to stand up to all of your camera phone extras.

Carrier network

More and more carriers are allowing photos taken by camera phones to be printed directly to a printer without

going through their network service. Check with your carrier to see whether your particular phone supports direct camera phone printing.

Remember, the best thing about a camera phone is that you are usually carrying one, so you are always ready when an unexpected photo opportunity occurs.

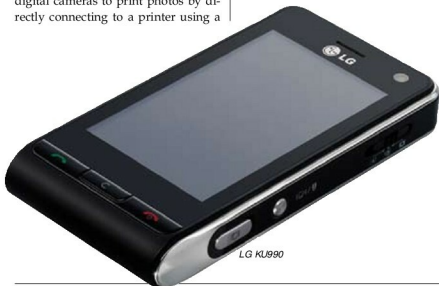
Try before you freeze

Try out the various phones before deciding to buy one. Feel its weight and try out the various features. Also, pay attention to whether it is easy to capture, save and e-mail pictures from the phone. Ideally, it shouldn't take more than two or three presses to e-mail a picture. You should also be able to send voice or text message with each picture.

Also make sure that your phone has enough memory to hold most of your pictures without affecting the speed and working of the phone. Try to buy one which has an expandable memory card slot for the same.

Last but not the least, it is best to go for a brand that is known for having the best cellphones. ●

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LG KU990